

Chapter

The Divine Power Every Woman Holds — Not Equality, but a Thousandfold Strength



Introduction: The Debate About Equality

Today one question comes up again and again in society — who is superior, woman or man? Women are struggling for their rights, struggling to be equal to men. Acharya Upendra ji looks at this debate from a completely different angle: according to him, the question is not one of equality at all, because a woman's power is already far greater — and along with that power comes a very great responsibility.

1. "Women Were Never Equal to Men"

Acharya ji paints a picture of today's debate:

"We are always fighting — between woman and man, who is superior? Women liberation, women's rights, likewise human rights, freedom and so on — so everyone is doing liberation and all that."

"So what do I always say? Women are fighting to be equal, equal to men."

And then he says something startling:

"I'm the only guru with authority — women were never equal to men, in any age. They were always a thousand times, at the very least, more powerful than them."

"While they are only thinking of equality, they are a thousand times more powerful."

A woman does not need to ask for equality — her power is already far greater.

2. Woman's Very Name Is "Shakti"

Acharya ji shows the basis for this in our own tradition:

"That is why women have been given the name 'Shakti'.
Goddess Parvati is called Shakti, Lakshmi is called
Shakti, Saraswati is called Shakti."

In the Sanatan tradition, Parvati, Lakshmi and Saraswati — all three goddesses — are called **Shakti**, the divine energy by which creation runs. **The very nature of woman is the nature of Shakti.**

3. This Power Is Not of the Body

But a question naturally arises — if a woman is so powerful, why does it not show? Acharya ji raises this question himself:

"So there is Shakti — but when? You will say, physically it does not look like that; she is called **abala**."

"It is not in the terms of body building, or how much weight one lifts, what one does — it is not in that language."

Abala means "one without strength". Acharya ji makes it clear that a woman's power cannot be measured in the language of muscles or lifting weights. **This power is not physical; it is of another level.**

4. A Mother Has a Thousand Times the Power of Her Child

Acharya ji explains where this power lies through the relationship between mother and child:

"She is powerful. There is a very great responsibility upon a woman. Which one? It is about the state when she gives birth to a son or a daughter."

"At that time, did that mother not have at least a thousand times more power than that child?"

From birth, a child depends entirely on the mother. Its upbringing, its values, its direction — everything is in the mother's hands. **This is a woman's real power: the ability to shape a new life.**

5. The Example of Gandhari

Acharya ji explains the responsibility tied to this power with an example from the Mahabharata — Duryodhana's mother, Gandhari:

"Duryodhana's mother — Gandhari — did she not have at least a thousand times the power when he was small?"

"As soon as he was born, they were rocking the child in the cradle — look from that time; when he was in school, look then. You did not use it then."

"Then you spoiled him so much with pampering and affection."

In childhood, when Duryodhana could have been given the right direction, that power was not used. And Acharya ji says plainly what follows from this:

"If knowledge was not given at the right time, if they themselves were rajasic and tamasic, then the sin of his whole life also inevitably comes upon her."

Rajasic and tamasic describe a nature governed by rajoguna and tamoguna — full of attachment, impulse and ignorance. If a mother does not give knowledge at the right time, the weight of her child's lifelong deeds falls on her too.

6. Every Woman's Karma, Every Woman's Responsibility

This is not limited to mothers alone:

"You will say, I did not marry — then you will be someone's sister, you will be something or other. So women have a great deal of karma."

Sister, daughter, mother — in one form or another, every woman influences the lives of others. And Acharya ji also makes it clear that this is not said to blame women:

"It has not been said calling her a sinner — the responsibility upon her is very great."

Where the power is greater, the responsibility is greater too.

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1** Women were never equal to men — they were always at least a thousand times more powerful. The fight for equality comes from forgetting this truth.
- 2** In the tradition, **Parvati, Lakshmi and Saraswati** are called "**Shakti**" — the very nature of woman is Shakti.
- 3** This **power is not measured in the language of physical strength** — "It is not in the terms of body building."
- 4** At birth, a mother has a thousand times more power than her child — the ability to shape that child.

- 5 **The example of Gandhari:** spoiling a child with pampering and not giving knowledge at the right time — then the sin of the child's life also falls on the mother.
- 6 **Every woman has a great deal of karma** — as mother, as sister, in any form. This is not blame, but **a very great responsibility.**

A woman does not need to ask anyone for equality to gain her power. What she needs is to recognise that power, and to use it at the right time — in giving knowledge and values.